

PROBLEM LOOKUP — READ FIRST

Question asks for...	Go to
power density $S(R, \theta)$ from a dipole	DIPOLE TYPE $\rightarrow$ HERTZIAN or ARB
HPBW β from $F(\theta)$	BEAM PARAM step 2
solid angle Ω_p / directivity D	BEAM PARAM step 3–4
$\theta_{\max}$, $S_{\max}$, plot $F(\theta)$	ARB-LENGTH DIPOLE
effective area A_e / ratio A_e/A_p	EFFECTIVE AREA
P_r given (link)	FRIIS FORMULA

Step 0 always: compute $\lambda = c/f$. Step 1: classify dipole by l/λ .

DIPOLE TYPE BY LENGTH

Compute first $\lambda = c/f$, then ratio l/λ		
l/λ	Type	Use formula
$< 1/50$	Hertzian (short)	HERTZIAN $S(R, \theta)$, $D=1.5$
$= 1/4$	Quarter-wave	ARB formula, $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/4$
$= 1/2$	Half-wave	half-wave shortcut, $D=1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}}=73\,\Omega$
$= 1$	Full-wave	ARB, $D=2.41$, $R_{\text{rad}}=199\,\Omega$
other	Arbitrary	ARB formula

If $l/\lambda < 1/50$ STOP and use Hertzian. Do NOT plug small l into the arbitrary formula — you'll get the wrong shape.

HERTZIAN DIPOLE — $S(R, \theta)$

Power density $l/\lambda < 1/50$; far field
$S(R, \theta) = \frac{\eta_0 k^2 I_0^2}{32\pi^2 R^2} \sin^2 \theta \text{ (W/m}^2\text{)}$
$k = 2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m); I_0 peak current (A); l length (m); R obs. dist (m).
Max direction broadside $\theta = \pi/2$
Total radiated power integrate over 4π
$P_{\text{rad}} = \frac{\eta_0 \pi}{3} \left(\frac{I_0 l}{\lambda}\right)^2 \text{ (W)}$
Directivity exact $D_{\text{Hertz}} = 1.5$ (1.76 dB)
Example (HW4 P1): $l = 1\text{m}$, $f = 1\text{MHz}$, $I_0 = 12\text{A}$, $R = 5\text{km}$, $\theta = 45^\circ$. $\lambda = 300\text{m}$, $l/\lambda = 1/300 < 1/50 \checkmark$.
$S = \frac{(120\pi)(2\pi/300)^2(144)(1)}{32\pi^2(5\times 10^3)^2} \cdot \frac{1}{2} = 1.51 \times 10^{-9} \text{ W/m}^2$.

ARBITRARY-LENGTH DIPOLE — $S(\theta)$

Power density any l , at distance R
$S(\theta) = \frac{15 I_0^2}{\pi R^2} \left[\frac{\cos\left(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda} \cos \theta\right) - \cos\left(\frac{\pi l}{\lambda}\right)}{\sin \theta} \right]^2$
Normalized pattern dimensionless $F(\theta) = S(\theta)/S_{\max}$
Half-wave $l = \lambda/2$ $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/2$, shortcut form
$S(\theta) = \frac{15 I_0^2}{\pi R^2} \frac{\cos^2(\frac{\pi}{2} \cos \theta)}{\sin^2 \theta}$
$D = 1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}} = 73\,\Omega$, $\theta_{\max} = \pi/2$.
Quarter-wave $l = \lambda/4$ $\pi l/\lambda = \pi/4$, $\cos(\pi/4) = \sqrt{2}/2$
$\frac{S(\theta)}{S_0} = \left[\frac{\cos(\frac{\pi}{4} \cos \theta) - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}}{\sin \theta} \right]^2$, $S_0 = \frac{15 I_0^2}{\pi R^2}$
$S_{\max} = S(\pi/2) = S_0 \left(1 - \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\right)^2 \approx 0.0858 S_0$
HW4 P3: $\theta_{\max} = \pi/2$ (broadside, same as half-wave); $S_{\max} = 0.0858 S_0$.

BEAM PARAMETERS — HPBW, Ω_p , D

Step 1 — Normalize always start here
$F(\theta) = S(\theta)/S_{\max}$
Step 2 — HPBW β solve $F(\theta_{1/2}) = 0.5$, then $\beta = 2\theta_{1/2}$ (symmetric beams)
Gaussian shortcut: $F = e^{-a\theta^2} = 0.5 \Rightarrow \theta_{1/2} = \sqrt{\ln 2/a}$.
HW4 P2: $F = e^{-20\theta^2}$, $a = 20 \Rightarrow \theta_{1/2} = \sqrt{\ln 2/20} = 0.186 \text{ rad}$, $\beta = 0.372 \text{ rad} = 21.31^\circ$.
Step 3 — Solid angle Ω_p (sr)
$\Omega_p = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta \, d\theta \, d\phi$
If F has no ϕ dep.: $\Omega_p = 2\pi \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta \, d\theta$.
Most integrals have NO closed form. Use Wolfram / numerical integration.
HW4 P2: $\Omega_p = 2\pi \int_0^\pi e^{-20\theta^2} \sin \theta \, d\theta = 0.156 \text{ sr}$ (numeric).
Step 4 — Directivity
$D = \frac{4\pi}{\Omega_p}$ (unitless) $D_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} D$
HW4 P2: $D = 4\pi/0.156 = 80.55$ (19.06 dB), very directive.
Step 5 — Gain $\xi = \text{radiation efficiency}$, $0 < \xi \leq 1$
$G = \xi D$ $G_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} G$
Lossless / ideal antenna $\Rightarrow G = D$.

COMMON DIPOLE PARAMETERS

Type	D	D_{dB}	R_{rad} (Ω)
Isotropic	1	0	—
Hertzian	1.5	1.76	$80\pi^2(l/\lambda)^2$
Half-wave	1.64	2.15	73
$l = \lambda$	2.41	3.82	199

Half-wave is the default “dipole antenna” unless stated otherwise.

EFFECTIVE AREA A_e

Definition antenna's RX cross section (m^2)
$A_e = \frac{\lambda^2 D}{4\pi} \text{ (m}^2\text{)}$
Physical cross section wire dipole, diameter d
$A_p = l d = \frac{\lambda}{2} d$ (half-wave)
Inverse: D from A_e
$D = \frac{4\pi A_e}{\lambda^2}$
HW4 P4: half-wave, $f = 100\text{MHz}$, $d = 2\text{cm}$. $\lambda = 3\text{m}$, $D = 1.64 \Rightarrow A_e = \frac{9(1.64)}{4\pi} = 1.17 \text{ m}^2$. $A_p = (1.5)(0.02) = 0.03 \text{ m}^2$. Ratio 39.2 $\times$.
Thin wires: $A_e \gg A_p$. Antenna captures field over $\sim \lambda$ region.

POWER FLOW IDENTITIES

$P_{\text{rad}} = S_{\max} \Omega_p R^2 = \frac{4\pi R^2 S_{\max}}{D}$
$S_{\max} = \frac{P_{\text{rad}} D}{4\pi R^2} \text{ (W/m}^2\text{)}$
Isotropic radiator: $S = P_{\text{rad}}/(4\pi R^2)$ (no D factor).

FRIIS TRANSMISSION FORMULA

Far-field link budget P_t tx, P_r rx, range R
$P_r = G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi R}\right)^2 P_t \text{ (W)}$
G_t, G_r linear gains; $\lambda = c/f$; R in m; P_t, P_r in W.
Solve for R max range
$R = \frac{\lambda}{4\pi} \sqrt{\frac{G_t G_r P_t}{P_r}} \text{ (m)}$
Solve for P_r using A_e equivalent form
$P_r = \frac{G_t P_t A_{e,r}}{4\pi R^2}$, $G_r = \frac{4\pi A_{e,r}}{\lambda^2}$
Free-space path loss: $L_{fs} = (4\pi R/\lambda)^2$, $P_r = G_t G_r P_t / L_{fs}$.
Use linear G . Convert dB first: $G_{\text{lin}} = 10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$.
HW4 P5: half-wave TX, $P_t = 1\text{kW}$, $f = 50\text{MHz}$, RX $G_r = 3\text{dB} = 2$, $R = 30\text{km}$. $\lambda = 6\text{m}$, $G_t = 1.64$. $P_r = (1.64)(2) \left(\frac{6}{4\pi \times 10^4}\right)^2 10^3 = 8.3 \times 10^{-7} \text{ W}$ (0.83 μW).

dB $\leftrightarrow$ LINEAR

$G_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} G_{\text{lin}}$		$G_{\text{lin}} = 10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$	
dB	linear	dB	linear
0	1	10	10
3	2	13	20
6	4	20	100
7	5	30	1000
−3	0.5	−10	0.1

For E-field or amplitude use $20 \log$ not $10 \log$ (power is squared).
Memorize: $3 \text{ dB} \Leftrightarrow \times 2$, $10 \text{ dB} \Leftrightarrow \times 10$. Add dB = multiply linear.

ANTENNA INTEGRATION TIPS

Ω_p integrals usually have no closed form.
Wolfram: <code>2*pi*Integrate[Exp[-20 t^2]*Sin[t],{t,0,pi}]</code> .
Narrow-beam shortcut Gaussian beam, $\theta_{1/2} \ll 1$
$\Omega_p \approx \frac{\pi \theta_{1/2}^2}{\ln 2}$ (approximate)
Only valid for narrow beams; HW4 P2 is borderline so use the integral.
Sanity check D compare to known antennas
$D < 2$: short / half-wave dipole. $D \sim 10$: small horn. $D > 100$: dish.

RADAR EQUATION (BONUS)

Monostatic radar $t_x = r_x$, target RCS σ_t (m^2)
$P_r = \frac{P_t G^2 \lambda^2 \sigma_t}{(4\pi)^3 R^4} \text{ (W)}$
Doppler shift closing velocity v_r
$f_d = \frac{2v_r}{\lambda} = \frac{2v_r f}{c} \text{ (Hz)}$
Factor 2 from round-trip path; v_r radial toward radar.
$f_d > 0$: target approaching. $1/R^4$ falloff vs. Friis $1/R^2$.

DIPOLE

l — antenna length (m)
$\lambda = c/f$ — wavelength (m)
I_0 — peak current (A)
$\eta_0 = 120\pi \approx 377\,\Omega$
$k = 2\pi/\lambda$ (rad/m)
R_{rad} — rad. res. (Ω)
R — obs. dist (m)

RADIATION

$S(R, \theta)$ — pwr dens. (W/m^2)
$S_{\max}$ — peak power density
$F(\theta) = S/S_{\max}$ normalized
Ω_p — solid angle (sr)
β — HPBW (rad or deg)
D — directivity (unitless)
P_{rad} — total power (W)

ANTENNA

$A_e = \lambda^2 D/(4\pi)$ eff. area
A_p — phys. cross sec. (m^2)
ξ — rad. eff. ($0 < \xi \leq 1$)
$G = \xi D$ — gain (linear)
$G_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log G$
Half-wave: $D = 1.64$, $R_{\text{rad}} = 73$
Hertzian: $D = 1.5$

FRIIS / LINK

P_t — tx power (W)
P_r — rx power (W)
G_t, G_r — linear gains
R — range (m)
$L_{fs} = (4\pi R/\lambda)^2$ path loss
3 dB $\rightarrow 2$; 10 dB $\rightarrow 10$
$G_{\text{lin}} = 10^{G_{\text{dB}}/10}$

RADAR

σ_t — RCS (m^2)
f_d — Doppler shift (Hz)
v_r — radial vel. (m/s)
$P_r \propto 1/R^4$ (monostatic)
$f_d = 2v_r/\lambda$ (round-trip)
$c = 3 \times 10^8 \text{ m/s}$
$f_d > 0$: target approaching